Answer key: Modismos packet

Answers for the Modismos packet. Teachers only — the packet page itself has no answers on it.

1. Match answers

1 = l, 2 = k, 3 = j, 4 = i, 5 = h, 6 = g, 7 = f, 8 = e, 9 = d, 10 = c, 11 = b, 12 = a

2. Match answers

1 = l, 2 = k, 3 = j, 4 = i, 5 = h, 6 = g, 7 = f, 8 = e, 9 = d, 10 = c, 11 = b, 12 = a

3. Missing words

Tomar el pelo = pelo; No tener ni idea = idea; Estar en las nubes = nubes; Meter la pata = pata; Echar una mano = mano; Estar hecho polvo = polvo; No pasa nada = nada; Ser pan comido = comido; Costar un ojo de la cara = cara; Hablar por los codos = codos; Estar entre la espada y la pared = pared; Tirar la toalla = toalla

4. Fitting idioms

1. Quedarse de piedra (to be stunned, frozen in shock); 2. Ser un hueso duro de roer (to be a tough nut to crack); 3. Buscarle tres pies al gato (to overcomplicate things, look for trouble); 4. Estar en un aprieto (to be in a tight spot, in a bind); 5. De película (amazing, like out of a movie); 6. ¡Qué genial! (how great! how cool!); 7. ¡Vaya! (wow! (surprise or admiration)); 8. ¡No me digas! (you don't say! no way!)

5. Use it in a sentence

Open answers — any sentence that shows the meaning counts.

6. Review quiz answers

A la larga = in the long run; A la vez = at the same time; A más no poder = as much as possible, to the utmost; A más tardar = at the latest; A primera vista = at first sight; A propósito = by the way; also, on purpose; A todo trance = at all costs; Al contrario = on the contrary; Al fin y al cabo = after all, when all is said and done; Al pie de la letra = word for word, exactly

7. Reflection

Open answers — any thoughtful response counts.

For the teacher

Purpose: move idioms from recognition to use — students first match meanings, then choose the right idiom for a situation, then write with them. Timing: about 40 minutes, or split across two days (exercises 1–3, then 4–7). Tip: exercise 4 works well read aloud — students defend their choice before you confirm it. Warn them never to translate idioms word by word in their own writing.